



OPTIONS, RISK, AND CAPITAL ASSOCIATION

Governance Charter and Bylaws

University of Colorado Boulder

Adopted 2026

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ARTICLE I: NAME AND PURPOSE

I. Name

A. The name of this organization is the Options, Risk, and Capital Association (ORCA).

II. Purpose

A. ORCA is a student-led investment organization focused on developing rigorous, disciplined approaches to markets, with an emphasis on derivatives, risk management, and capital allocation.

B. The organization operates with the objective of:

1. Developing analytical and probabilistic thinking in financial decision-making.
2. Evaluating investment strategies with a focus on risk-adjusted returns and asymmetric outcomes.
3. Creating a structured environment for market analysis, debate, and performance review.
4. Preparing members for careers in investment management, trading, and related fields.

ARTICLE II: MEMBERSHIP

I. Eligibility

A. Membership is open to all currently enrolled students at the University of Colorado Boulder, regardless of academic background or prior experience.

B. "In accordance with University policy, this recognized student organization is open to all CU Boulder students and does not discriminate based on race, color, national origin, sex, age, disability, creed, religion, veteran status, marital status, political affiliation, political philosophy, pregnancy, sexual orientation, gender identity or gender expression in accordance with state, federal, and Regent law."

II. Expectations

A. Members are expected to attend meetings regularly.

B. Members are expected to engage in discussions and organizational activities.

C. Members are expected to uphold standards of professionalism, respect, and intellectual integrity.

III. Removal

A. Membership may be revoked by a majority vote of the Executive Board for repeated disruptive or disrespectful conduct, failure to adhere to organizational standards, or behavior inconsistent with the mission of ORCA.

ARTICLE III: ANALYST PROGRAM

I. Role of Analysts

A. Analysts represent the core investment group within ORCA and are expected to contribute actively to the organization's analytical and strategic efforts.

II. Eligibility

A. To be considered for Analyst status, members must demonstrate consistent attendance and engagement.

- B. To be considered for Analyst status, members must be in good standing within the organization.

III. Selection Process

- A. Analysts are selected through a structured process that may include application submission, interview with Executive Board members, and evaluation of analytical ability and commitment.
- B. Selection requires majority approval by the Executive Board.

IV. Expectations and Responsibilities

- A. Analysts are expected to present structured analyses of market events, strategies, or trade ideas.
- B. Analysts are expected to demonstrate understanding of risk, return, and scenario-based thinking.
- C. Analysts are expected to contribute meaningfully to discussions and peer evaluation.
- D. Analysts are expected to maintain consistent participation in analyst-level meetings.

V. Evaluation and Removal

- A. Analyst status is subject to ongoing evaluation.
- B. An Analyst may be removed by majority vote of the Executive Board for failure to meet participation or performance expectations, or for conduct inconsistent with the standards of the organization.

ARTICLE IV: EXECUTIVE BOARD

I. Structure

- A. The Executive Board is responsible for governance, strategy, and operational oversight of ORCA.
- B. Core roles include President, Vice President, and Treasurer.
- C. Additional roles may be created as needed, subject to Board approval.

II. Responsibilities

- A. The President provides overall strategic direction and leadership, presides over meetings, represents ORCA to external stakeholders, and ensures adherence to bylaws and organizational standards.
- B. The Vice President supports execution of initiatives and internal coordination, acts as liaison between members and leadership, and assists in strategic and operational planning.
- C. The Treasurer oversees financial management, budgeting, and recordkeeping, ensures transparency and financial accountability, and provides regular financial updates to the Board.

III. Selection and Terms

- A. Executive Board members are selected through a formal application and evaluation process.
- B. Selection requires majority approval of the existing Executive Board.
- C. Terms shall last one academic year, with eligibility for reappointment.

IV. Removal

- A. An Executive Board member may be removed by a two-thirds vote of the Executive Board for failure to fulfill responsibilities, misconduct, or breach of organizational standards.

ARTICLE V: DECISION-MAKING AND GOVERNANCE

I. Voting

- A. All major decisions require a majority vote of the Executive Board.
- B. Each Board member holds one vote.

II. Quorum

- A. A quorum is defined as a majority of Executive Board members.
- B. No official decisions may be made without quorum.

III. Major Decisions

- A. The following actions require Board approval: amendments to bylaws, significant financial expenditures, analyst selections and removals, and Executive Board appointments or removals.

ARTICLE VI: MEETINGS

I. Frequency

- A. General meetings shall be held biweekly.
- B. Analyst meetings shall be held on alternating weeks.
- C. Executive Board meetings shall be held at least monthly.

II. Structure

- A. General meetings are open to all members.
- B. Analyst meetings are restricted to Analysts and Executive Board members.
- C. Executive Board meetings are restricted to Executive Board members.

ARTICLE VII: FINANCIAL GOVERNANCE

I. Oversight

- A. Financial operations are overseen by the Treasurer with involvement from the Executive Board.

II. Approval Requirements

- A. Routine expenses may be approved by the Treasurer.
- B. Any expenditure exceeding a defined threshold must be approved by a majority of the Executive Board.
- C. All expenditures must be documented and recorded.

III. Accountability

- A. Financial records must be maintained and made available to the Executive Board and Faculty Advisor upon request.
- B. Regular financial updates shall be provided to ensure transparency.

ARTICLE VIII: CONDUCT AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

I. Standards

A. All members are expected to uphold professionalism, respect, and intellectual honesty.

II. Complaints

A. Any member may submit a complaint to the Executive Board.

B. The Board will review and investigate concerns in a timely manner.

III. Resolution

A. Decisions regarding disciplinary action require a majority vote of the Executive Board.

B. Escalation procedures may be implemented if necessary.

ARTICLE IX: AMENDMENTS

I. Proposal

A. Any member may propose amendments to these bylaws.

II. Approval

A. Amendments require review by the Executive Board.

B. Amendments require approval by a two-thirds majority vote.

III. Review Cycle

A. These bylaws shall be reviewed at least once per academic year to ensure continued relevance and effectiveness.

FINAL STATEMENT

ORCA is designed to operate with a level of rigor and accountability that reflects real-world investment environments. Its structure emphasizes disciplined thinking, transparency, and continuous evaluation, with the goal of developing members who can approach markets with both analytical precision and sound judgment.